Cross-Market Strategy Playbook

Five practical setups for gold and bitcoin around the U.S. close, Asian open, weekend, and U.S. cash-session reopen.

What this set includes

- This playbook assumes you already have a cross-market map: lead market, ETF reference, implied move, and major strikes.
- Every setup is conditional. The same level can behave very differently if the move is inside implied versus outside implied.

How to use the playbook

Every setup begins with the same universal filters.

- Identify the lead market first. Do not let the quiet wrapper tell you what the live wrapper is doing.
- Translate the live move into ETF terms before you look for support or resistance.
- Compute a simple shock ratio so you know whether the move was already priced.
- Treat strike clusters as decision zones, not as guaranteed walls.
- If execution quality is poor—wide spreads, thin depth, or event risk you do not understand—do not force the trade.

Quick filter	Preferred	Danger
Shock ratio	Inside or near implied	Far outside implied
Liquidity state	Acceptable spreads and normal depth	Thin quotes or disorderly reopen
Cluster quality	OI + fresh volume + confluence	Stale OI alone
Catalyst	No major surprise	Fresh macro, policy, custody, or benchmark shock

Setup 1: Gold Asian-open liquidity correction

U.S. options are shut, gold futures keep moving, and the move is small enough relative to priced risk that it may simply be probing for liquidity.

Field	Playbook note
What to compare	GC % move versus the prior GLD implied move; projected GLD fair value; mapped GLD strike zones in GC space.
Entry idea	Only consider a fade after price reaches a strong mapped zone and shows rejection or failure to extend. Let your technical trigger do the timing.
Invalidation	Price accepts below the mapped zone and continues toward the next strike cluster with better participation.
Targets / management	First target = overnight midpoint or prior settlement; next target = the next internal liquidity zone or VWAP-like reference you use.
Avoid when	Shock ratio > 1, obvious macro catalyst, or Europe quickly confirms the move.
Illustrative example	GC falls from 3320 to 3304, projected GLD fair value lands near 305, and the move remains inside the prior one-day expected range.

Setup 2: Gold U.S. cash-session reconciliation

Futures moved overnight; GLD and GLD options now have to catch up when the U.S. cash session opens.

Field	Playbook note
What to compare	Opening GLD gap versus the fair value implied by GC; the first 15 minutes of live IV response; whether price is opening directly into a mapped strike cluster.
Entry idea	Trade the reconciliation after the open tells you whether price is accepting or rejecting fair value. If GLD overshoots a strong cluster and snaps back, mean reversion is plausible; if it opens near fair value and holds the overnight direction, continuation is plausible.
Invalidation	The open keeps repricing in the same direction and live IV expands with it after the first 15-minute balance period.
Targets / management	Targets can be fair-value reversion, opening-range extremes, or the next mapped strike depending on whether you are fading or following.
Avoid when	Chaotic opening auction, spreads that remain too wide, or a major scheduled release immediately after the open.
Illustrative example	Overnight gold weakness is modest, but GLD opens too far below fair value into a 305-equivalent zone and quickly rejects it.

Setup 3: GLD strike-cluster reaction trade

A large nearby strike acts as a decision zone because positioning and hedging may intensify there.

Field	Playbook note
What to compare	The size of nearby OI, whether fresh same-day volume also traded there, the expiry distance, and the same level translated back into GC.
Entry idea	Treat the strike as a zone to trade around, not a wall to front-run. Wait for acceptance or rejection using the tape or technical trigger you trust.
Invalidation	Price trades cleanly through the zone, fresh volume follows, and the next strike cluster becomes the better map.
Targets / management	Targets can be the next strike, the middle of the local range, or the opposite side of the session balance depending on your direction.
Avoid when	The strike is far from expiry, OI is stale, volume is absent, or the futures map does not confirm the zone.
Illustrative example	GLD 305 has heavy nearby interest and maps to GC ≈ 3307. If GC tests 3307 and cannot stay below it, the zone is doing its job.

Setup 4: Bitcoin weekend-to-Monday ETF gap

Bitcoin kept trading all weekend; the ETF and ETF options did not. Monday is a wrapper-repricing event first.

Field	Playbook note
What to compare	Weekend spot / CME move versus Friday’s IBIT implied move; Friday’s mapped IBIT strikes; any benchmark or custody-specific news.
Entry idea	If the weekend move is still inside or near expected risk and IBIT opens into a strong strike cluster, a corrective reaction is plausible. If the move is far outside expected risk, let the market show you acceptance before you chase or fade.
Invalidation	The open keeps extending with volume and IV repricing in the same direction, or a catalyst clearly upgrades the move.
Targets / management	Targets can be a fill toward fair value, the opening-range edge, or the next mapped strike depending on whether the open is correcting or continuing.
Avoid when	Shock ratio is very high, crypto-specific operational news hits, or basis makes the translation unreliable.
Illustrative example	BTC falls 6% over the weekend while Friday’s IBIT chain only priced about a $1.10 one-day move. Monday is more likely a repricing session than routine noise.

Setup 5: Bitcoin U.S.-close to Asia handoff

IBIT options are shut, but bitcoin spot and CME futures keep trading. The next U.S. session's ETF map still matters even though the ETF is asleep.

Field	Playbook note
What to compare	Live BTC move versus the last U.S. ETF implied move; key IBIT strikes translated back into BTC levels; the quality of overnight crypto liquidity.
Entry idea	Use the handoff mostly for mapping and preparation unless your execution in overnight crypto liquidity is genuinely reliable. The best use is often to carry a better map into the next U.S. reopen.
Invalidation	Spot breaks decisively outside the prior expected range and keeps accepting new prices in a way that invalidates the old ETF map.
Targets / management	Primary targets are the translated strike zones that are likely to matter when the U.S. cash session and ETF options re-engage.
Avoid when	Weekend or major crypto-specific headlines, or when you are forcing a U.S. options map onto a fundamentally different overnight regime.
Illustrative example	BTC drifts toward a translated IBIT strike overnight. That tells you where U.S. participants may care tomorrow, even though the ETF options chain is not live right now.

No-trade conditions

Sometimes the best cross-market read is that the inputs are too noisy.

- You cannot identify the lead market.
- The move cannot be scaled to the same horizon as the implied-volatility estimate.
- Spreads or depth are too poor to execute cleanly.
- The only argument is 'there is lots of OI there.'
- A catalyst is clearly changing the regime and you are trying to fade it just because price looks extended on one chart.

Trade review worksheet

Print this page or copy the fields into your journal.

Field	Notes
Setup used	
Lead market	
Reference prices (futures / ETF)	
Prior implied move	
Shock ratio	
Key strike clusters	
Execution trigger	
Invalidation level	
Outcome	
What the cross-market read got right / wrong	

Playbook rule

A good setup is not just a good chart pattern.

It is a chart pattern that still makes sense after you compare live price discovery, the cash-session wrapper, and the options market’s prior expectations.